

Full-spectrum percentage-based 10k training schedule (metric)

16 week, peak volume of 120 km/wk – all percentages are relative to *current* 10k fitness

General Phase							
Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	6 sets of: 2 min at 105% 1 min jog 1 min at 108% 1.5 min jog	11–13 km easy*	8 km at 90%	AM: 8–12 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy	10 km Kenyan-style progression run	18–20 km easy through rolling hills	6–10 km very easy Volume: 89 km
2	4 sets of: 3 min at 100% 1 min jog 2 min at 105% 2 min jog	11–13 km easy	AM: 5 × 1200m at 96–97%, 1 min jog PM: 3 sets of: 300m at 110–112% 2 min walk 200m at 113–115% 3–4 min walk/jog	8–10 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy	13 km at 85%	Off or 6–10 km very easy Volume: 97 km
3	AM: 11–13 km easy to moderate PM: 5–6 km easy	12 km Kenyan-style progression run	11–15 km easy	10 km at 90%	AM: 11–13 km easy PM: 5–8 km easy	20–22 km easy through rolling hills	8–12 km very easy Volume: 102 km
4	3 sets of: 3 min at 100–102% 1 min jog 2 min at 104–106% 1 min jog 1 min at 106–108%	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	AM: 3 × 2 km at 91–93%, 2 min jog PM: 12 × 400m at 99–101%, 25 sec walk	10–12 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy to moderate	5 × 1500m at 96–97%, 1 min jog	13–16 km easy Volume: 110 km

*See last page for guidelines on very easy, easy, moderate, and strong paces

Read more about the design of this schedule at runningwritings.com/2024/10/percentage-based-10k-training.html

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
5	AM: 8–10 km moderate PM: 6–8 km easy	14 km Kenyan- style progression run	10–13 km easy	10 × 2 min at 105% w/ 1.5 min jog	AM: 8–10 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	16 km at 85%	Off <i>or</i> 6–8 km very easy Volume: 97 km
6	AM: 10–13 km easy to moderate PM: 6–8 km easy	AM: 6 km at 95% PM: 10 × 500m at 99–101%, 30 sec walk	8–12 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km moderate	8 × 1000m at 100% w/ 1 min jog	10–13 km very easy to easy	24–25 km easy through rolling hills Volume: 113 km
Race-Supportive Phase							
7	8–12 km very easy to easy	AM: 4 × 2 km at 91–93%, 2 min PM: 5 × 300m at 110–112% w/ 2–3 min walk	10–12 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	12 km at 90%	11–15 km very easy	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy Volume: 115 km
8	4 sets of : 1200m at 100% 1min walk 800m at 103–105% 3–4 min walk/jog	11–15 km very easy to easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy to moderate	6 sets of: 1200m at 96–97%, 400m at 85–86%	11–15 km very easy	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	7 km at 84% 6 km at 86% 6 km at 88% Volume: 120 km

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
9	Off <i>or</i> 6–10 km very easy	10–13 km very easy to easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km moderate	AM: 8 km at 95% PM: 2 sets of: 400m, 300m, 200m at 110–115% w/ 2 min walk & 4–5 min walk/jog (reps / sets)	10–13 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	14 km at 90% Volume: 108 km
10	11–15 km very easy to easy	AM: 8–12 km easy PM: 6–8 km moderate	2 sets of: 6 × 500m at 105% w/ 45–60 sec walk/jog & 4–5 min walk/jog	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy to moderate	5 sets of: 1600m at 96–97%, 400m at 85–86%	10–13 km very easy Volume: 120 km
Race-Specific Phase							
11	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	AM: 8–12 km easy to moderate PM: 6–8 km moderate to strong	4 × 2 km at 100% w/ 3–4 min jog	11–15 km easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy	15–16 km at 90%	10–13 km very easy to easy Volume: 120 km
12	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy	10–13 km very easy	<i>Special block</i> AM: 6 km at 85–90%, 3–5 min rest, 4 km at 102–103% PM: 6 km at 85– 90%, 3–5 min rest, 2 × (600m, 400m, 300m, 200m) at 110–115% w/ 1 min walk & 4–5 min walk/jog	8–10 km very easy	AM: 10–13 km very easy PM: 5–6 km very easy (<i>optional</i>)	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 6–8 km easy to moderate	10–12 km at 95% Volume: 105–120 km

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
13	10–13 km very easy to easy	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy	5 × 2 km at 100% w/ 3–4 min jog	10–13 km very easy	AM: 10–13 km very easy to easy PM: 5–6 km very easy	16–18 km at 90%	10–13 km very easy Volume: 105–115 km
14	11–15 km easy	AM: 8–10 km easy PM: 6–8 km moderate	6 × 1 km at 105% w/ 2–3 min jog	10–13 km very easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 5–8 km easy (<i>optional</i>)	7–8 sets of: 1 km at 95%, 1 km at 85%	10–13 km very easy Volume: 105–115 km
15	11–15 km easy	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy (<i>optional</i>)	3 km at 100% 4–5 min rest 2 km at 101% 3–4 min rest 2 km at 102% 3–4 min rest 1 km at 106–108%	11–15 km very easy to easy	AM: 11–15 km easy PM: 5–8 km easy (<i>optional</i>)	4–5 × 2 km at 91–93% w/ 2 min walk	10–13 km very easy Volume: 90–100 km
16	10–13 km easy	4–5 × 1200m at 96–97% w/ 1 min jog, then: 4 × 200m at 108–110% w/ 200m jog	AM: 10–13 km easy PM: 5–6 km easy (<i>optional</i>)	8–13 km easy	10–13 km easy	10k race	6–8 km very easy Volume: 70–100 km

Notes:

- Warm-ups and cool-downs are not listed on the schedule, but are incorporated into the mileage goals
 - In general, 2–3 km progressive warm-up plus strides and 2–3 km easy cool-down makes sense. Double threshold, evening speed, and special blocks should use significantly less warm-up and cool-down volume, while long fast runs need little or no cool-down.
- Revise your current 10k fitness estimate every four weeks, based on how your workouts go (*there is a bit of an art to this!*).
- You can add strides or hill sprints once or twice per week if desired.
- Volume in the race-specific phase is not as important; adjust as needed to recover and feel fresh for workouts. Ditto for taper mileage.

Pace and effort guidelines

These are *approximate guidelines* for calibrating your effort, not hard and fast rules. Different runners will convert up or convert down better or worse. For example, a strong long-distance specialist could run faster than 95% 10k pace for the half marathon, while a more speed-oriented runner may be able to manage better than 110% 10k pace for the 3k.

For calculating percentages, use my free race pace percentage calculator at apps.runningwritings.com/pace-percent

Pace	Effort level (approximate)
45–55% 10k	Very easy run / shakeout jog pace
55–65% 10k	Easy run pace / Daniels “E” pace
70–80% 10k	Moderate run pace
85% 10k	Steady run pace / LT1
90% 10k	Strong run pace / “Predicted marathon pace” / Daniels “M” pace
91–93% 10k	“Sub-threshold”
95% 10k	Half marathon pace
96–97% 10k	“Threshold” / LT2 / SSmax / CS- / Daniels “T” pace
100% 10k	10k pace
102% 10k	8k to optimistic 8k pace / Tinman “CV” pace / CS+
105% 10k	5k pace
108% 10k	Conservative 3k to 3k pace / vVO2max / Daniels “I” pace
110% 10k	3k to optimistic 3k pace
115% 10k	Conservative to optimistic mile pace / Daniels “R” pace